

CONTINENTAL ESPORTS FOOTBALL LEAGUE

Official Competition Rulebook

Edition 4.2 | Season 2026-27

Continental Esports Football Association
Torre Aurelia, Level 22, Avenida del Puerto 1188, Valmora
Approved by the CEFA Board on 11 July 2026
In force from 1 August 2026

Deposited under reference CEFA-RB-4.2-2026

PART I — PRELIMINARY PROVISIONS

Article 1 — Name and Governing Authority

- 1.1 The competition governed by this Rulebook is the Continental Esports Football League, hereinafter "the League" or "CEFL".
- 1.2 The League is owned, organised and administered by the Continental Esports Football Association ("CEFA"), a non-profit association registered in the city of Valmora under registry number CEFA-2019-0447.
- 1.3 CEFA was constituted on 14 February 2019 by nine founding clubs and admitted its first full season of competition in September 2019.
- 1.4 The registered seat of CEFA is Torre Aurelia, Level 22, Avenida del Puerto 1188, Valmora. All formal notices under this Rulebook shall be validly served at that address or at the official electronic address legal@cefa.esport.
- 1.5 This Rulebook is Edition 4.2 and enters into force on 1 August 2026. It supersedes Edition 4.1 in its entirety, including all circulars issued under it.

Article 2 — Scope of Application

- 2.1 This Rulebook binds CEFA, all licensed clubs, all registered players, all registered staff, all match officials, and any third party who accepts its terms as a condition of accreditation.
- 2.2 Participation in any CEFA competition constitutes unconditional acceptance of this Rulebook, of the CEFA Statutes, and of the decisions of CEFA judicial bodies.
- 2.3 Where this Rulebook conflicts with a club's internal regulations, this Rulebook prevails.
- 2.4 Where this Rulebook conflicts with the published Game Manual of the Title, this Rulebook prevails except in matters of pure software behaviour, which are governed by Article 34.
- 2.5 The Spanish and English texts of this Rulebook are both official. In the event of divergence, the English text prevails.

Article 3 — Definitions

For the purposes of this Rulebook the following definitions apply.

- 3.1 "Title" means the video game Total Football 26, published by Meridian Interactive S.A., in the build distributed through the CEFA Tournament Client.
- 3.2 "Tournament Client" means the CEFA-administered software distribution, version 9.x, through which all competitive matches are launched, recorded and verified.
- 3.3 "Game" means a single completed instance of play within the Title, comprising two halves of six real-time minutes each.
- 3.4 "Leg" is a synonym of Game when used in the context of a Fixture.

- 3.5 "Fixture" means the complete competitive encounter between two clubs on a scheduled date, comprising two Legs played consecutively, resolved on aggregate score.
- 3.6 "Series" means any sequence of Fixtures between the same two clubs within a single knockout round.
- 3.7 "Match Window" means the period, ordinarily from Thursday 18:00 to Sunday 22:00 Valmora time, in which the Fixtures of a given Round are played.
- 3.8 "Round" means the complete set of Fixtures scheduled within one Match Window.
- 3.9 "Roster" means the list of players registered to a club and eligible to be fielded, as recorded in the CEFA Registration System.
- 3.10 "Matchsheet" means the document submitted before each Fixture naming the Starting Player, the Substitutes and the Designated Coach.
- 3.11 "Starting Player" means the player who controls the club's side at the kick-off of Leg A.
- 3.12 "Designated Coach" means the single staff member entitled to occupy the coaching position during play and to request a Timeout.
- 3.13 "Elite Division" means the first tier of the League.
- 3.14 "Open Division" means the second tier of the League.
- 3.15 "Competition Manager" means the CEFA officer with operational authority over a Match Window.
- 3.16 "Head Referee" means the official appointed to supervise a specific Fixture.
- 3.17 "Technical Committee" means the CEFA body responsible for build adoption, hardware standards and connection standards.
- 3.18 "Disciplinary Panel" means the first-instance judicial body of CEFA.
- 3.19 "Appeals Panel" means the second-instance judicial body of CEFA.
- 3.20 "Valmora time" means Coordinated Universal Time minus four hours, without seasonal adjustment.
- 3.21 "Season" means the competitive period running from 1 August of one calendar year to 31 July of the following calendar year.
- 3.22 "Continental Player" means a player holding citizenship of a territory affiliated to CEFA. All other players are "Overseas Players".
- 3.23 "Academy Player" means a registered player who has not reached the age of nineteen on the first day of the Season.
- 3.24 "Credit" means the accounting unit used in CEFA financial schedules, fixed at one United States dollar.

Article 4 — Competition Structure

- 4.1 The League comprises two divisions in vertical relationship: the Elite Division and the Open Division.
- 4.2 The Elite Division comprises sixteen clubs.
- 4.3 The Open Division comprises twenty clubs.
- 4.4 Each division plays a double round-robin regular season in which every club meets every other club twice, once as Home Club and once as Away Club.
- 4.5 Accordingly an Elite Division club plays thirty regular-season Fixtures and an Open Division club plays thirty-eight regular-season Fixtures.
- 4.6 The Elite Division regular season of Season 2026-27 begins on 12 September 2026 and concludes on 28 March 2027.
- 4.7 The Open Division regular season of Season 2026-27 begins on 5 September 2026 and concludes on 11 April 2027.
- 4.8 The Elite Division regular season is followed by the Championship Playoffs, contested by the eight highest-placed clubs.
- 4.9 The Open Division regular season is followed by the Promotion Playoffs, contested by the clubs placed second to fifth.
- 4.10 The club placed first in the Open Division at the conclusion of the regular season is promoted directly and does not enter the Promotion Playoffs.

Article 5 — Promotion and Relegation

- 5.1 The two clubs placed fifteenth and sixteenth in the Elite Division at the conclusion of the regular season are relegated to the Open Division.
- 5.2 The club placed first in the Open Division and the winner of the Promotion Playoffs are promoted to the Elite Division.
- 5.3 The club placed fourteenth in the Elite Division contests the Survival Fixture against the losing finalist of the Promotion Playoffs.
- 5.4 The Survival Fixture is a single Fixture of two Legs played at a neutral venue on a date fixed by CEFA no later than 9 May 2027.
- 5.5 If the Survival Fixture is level on aggregate after both Legs, a third Leg of six real-time minutes in total is played, in which the away-goals principle does not apply.
- 5.6 The club placed fourteenth in the Elite Division retains its Elite place if it wins the Survival Fixture.
- 5.7 A club relegated under this Article forfeits its Elite Division licence deposit in accordance with Article 62.

Article 6 — Calendar and Match Windows

- 6.1 Elite Division Fixtures are ordinarily played on Fridays and Saturdays within the Match Window.
- 6.2 Open Division Fixtures are ordinarily played on Thursdays and Sundays within the Match Window.
- 6.3 CEFA publishes the full Season calendar no later than 15 July preceding the Season.
- 6.4 CEFA may reschedule any Fixture on not less than seventy-two hours' notice to both clubs.
- 6.5 A club may request the rescheduling of a Fixture not later than fourteen days before the scheduled date, stating grounds. Requests filed later are admissible only on grounds of force majeure.
- 6.6 No club may be required to play more than three Fixtures within any period of seven consecutive days.
- 6.7 The interval between the conclusion of Leg A and the kick-off of Leg B shall be not less than five minutes and not more than twelve minutes.
- 6.8 A club whose Starting Player is not present in the Tournament Client lobby at the scheduled kick-off time is allowed a grace period of eight minutes.
- 6.9 Expiry of the grace period without presence results in forfeiture of the Leg under Article 30.

PART II — CLUB LICENSING AND ADMINISTRATION

Article 7 — The Licence

- 7.1 No club may participate in a CEFA competition without a valid Competition Licence for the relevant division and Season.
- 7.2 Licences are granted annually by the CEFA Licensing Department and are not transferable.
- 7.3 Applications for a licence must be filed no later than 30 June preceding the Season.
- 7.4 A licence application shall include the club's constitutional documents, proof of legal personality, audited accounts for the preceding financial year, evidence of the Financial Reserve required by Article 9, and the name of the Compliance Officer.
- 7.5 The Licensing Department shall decide each application no later than 20 July and shall state reasons for any refusal.
- 7.6 A refusal may be appealed to the Appeals Panel within seven days of notification.

Article 8 — Licence Categories and Fees

- 8.1 The Elite Division Licence carries an annual fee of 45,000 credits.
- 8.2 The Open Division Licence carries an annual fee of 12,000 credits.
- 8.3 A club promoted from the Open Division pays the difference between the two fees within thirty days of promotion being confirmed.
- 8.4 A club relegated from the Elite Division is not entitled to a refund of any part of the Elite fee.
- 8.5 Licence fees are payable in two instalments, the first of sixty per cent by 1 August and the second of forty per cent by 15 November.
- 8.6 Late payment attracts interest at one and a half per cent per month, calculated daily.

Article 9 — Financial Reserve

- 9.1 Each Elite Division club shall maintain a Financial Reserve of not less than 120,000 credits, held in a segregated account with a bank recognised by CEFA.
- 9.2 Each Open Division club shall maintain a Financial Reserve of not less than 30,000 credits.
- 9.3 The Reserve exists to guarantee player salaries for a minimum of three months and may not be pledged as security for any other obligation.
- 9.4 A club whose Reserve falls below the required threshold shall restore it within twenty-one days of written notice from CEFA.
- 9.5 Failure to restore the Reserve within the period set in 9.4 results in a transfer embargo under Article 24 and a fine under Appendix C.
- 9.6 CEFA may inspect the Reserve account at any time on seven days' notice.

Article 10 — Club Officers

- 10.1 Each club shall designate a Compliance Officer, a Team Manager and a Media Officer. One natural person may hold not more than two of these positions.
- 10.2 The Compliance Officer is the sole channel for formal communication with CEFA on registration, disciplinary and licensing matters.
- 10.3 Changes of Compliance Officer take effect only upon written acknowledgement by CEFA.
- 10.4 The Team Manager is responsible for the accuracy of the Matchsheet and bears personal responsibility for any false statement contained in it.
- 10.5 The Media Officer is responsible for compliance with Part IX.

Article 11 — Club Identity

- 11.1 A club's name, crest and primary colours are registered with CEFA and may not be altered during a Season.
- 11.2 An application to change club identity for a following Season shall be filed no later than 15 June and requires the approval of the CEFA Board.
- 11.3 A club may not adopt a name, crest or colour scheme liable to be confused with those of another licensed club.
- 11.4 A change of controlling ownership does not of itself authorise a change of club identity.
- 11.5 A club that relocates its registered city shall notify CEFA within fifteen days and shall play no fewer than half of its home LAN engagements in the new city during the following Season.

Article 12 — Home Club Duties

- 12.1 The Home Club of a Fixture is the club named first in the published calendar.
- 12.2 The Home Club selects the server region from the list approved under Article 33, subject to the Away Club's right of objection under 12.4.
- 12.3 The Home Club provides the observer slot credentials to the Head Referee not less than thirty minutes before kick-off.
- 12.4 The Away Club may object to the selected server region not later than four hours before kick-off if the projected latency for its Starting Player exceeds the standard in Article 33. The Competition Manager decides the objection and the decision is final.
- 12.5 The Home Club plays Leg A with the home kit and the left-hand side selection; these are reversed for Leg B.

PART III — PLAYERS, CONTRACTS AND TRANSFERS

Article 13 — Registration

- 13.1 A player is eligible to be fielded only if registered to the club in the CEFA Registration System before the applicable deadline.
- 13.2 The registration deadline for a Fixture is 23:59 Valmora time on the Tuesday preceding the Match Window.
- 13.3 A player may be registered to only one club at any time across both divisions.
- 13.4 Registration requires a signed contract, proof of identity, proof of age, and the player's acceptance of the CEFA Integrity Code.
- 13.5 A player registered after the second Match Window of the regular season is not eligible for individual awards under Appendix B unless the player appears in at least sixty per cent of the club's remaining Fixtures.
- 13.6 CEFA shall confirm or reject a registration within forty-eight hours of a complete filing.

Article 14 — Roster Composition

- 14.1 An Elite Division club shall register not fewer than six and not more than nine players.
- 14.2 An Open Division club shall register not fewer than five and not more than eight players.
- 14.3 An Elite Division club shall include at least one Academy Player in its registered Roster at all times.
- 14.4 An Elite Division club may register not more than three Overseas Players.
- 14.5 An Open Division club may register not more than two Overseas Players.
- 14.6 A club whose Roster falls below the minimum by reason of injury, illness or contract termination shall restore it within twenty-eight days.
- 14.7 A club that has not restored its Roster within the period set in 14.6 may not field a side and forfeits each affected Fixture under Article 30.

Article 15 — Age and Capacity

- 15.1 The minimum age for registration in the Open Division is fifteen years on the first day of the Season.
- 15.2 The minimum age for registration in the Elite Division is sixteen years on the first day of the Season.
- 15.3 A player under the age of eighteen requires the written consent of a parent or legal guardian, renewed each Season.
- 15.4 A player under the age of eighteen may not be fielded in a Fixture that concludes after 23:00 Valmora time.

15.5 A club fielding a player in breach of 15.4 forfeits the Fixture and incurs a fine under Appendix C.

Article 16 — Contracts

16.1 Every registered player shall hold a written contract with the club.

16.2 The minimum duration of a player contract is twelve months. Contracts of shorter duration are admissible only for emergency signings under Article 20.

16.3 The maximum duration of a player contract is four years, or three years where the player is under the age of eighteen at signature.

16.4 The minimum monthly remuneration in the Elite Division is 2,400 credits.

16.5 The minimum monthly remuneration in the Open Division is 900 credits.

16.6 Remuneration shall be paid not later than the fifth day of the month following that to which it relates.

16.7 A club in arrears of more than thirty days entitles the player to terminate the contract with just cause on fifteen days' written notice.

16.8 Contract clauses conditioning any part of remuneration on sporting results are void unless the variable portion does not exceed thirty-five per cent of total remuneration.

16.9 A release clause, where agreed, shall be stated as a fixed sum in credits and may not be indexed to competition results.

Article 17 — Transfer Windows

17.1 The Primary Transfer Window opens on 1 July and closes on 25 August.

17.2 The Secondary Transfer Window opens on 27 December and closes on 14 January.

17.3 Registrations outside a Transfer Window are admissible only under Articles 19 and 20.

17.4 A transfer is complete when CEFA records it in the Registration System, not when the clubs sign the agreement.

17.5 A filing received after the closing hour of a Window is rejected irrespective of the time of signature, save where the delay is attributable to a failure of CEFA systems evidenced by the system log.

Article 18 — Transfer Procedure

18.1 A transfer requires the tripartite agreement of the transferring club, the acquiring club and the player.

18.2 The acquiring club files the transfer with CEFA together with proof of settlement of any transfer compensation or evidence of an agreed instalment schedule.

18.3 Transfer compensation exceeding 250,000 credits shall be notified to the CEFA Financial Control Unit with supporting evidence of funding.

18.4 A club may not acquire more than four players in a single Transfer Window.

18.5 A player may not be party to more than two completed transfers within a single Season.

18.6 Sell-on clauses are permitted up to a maximum of twenty per cent of any subsequent transfer compensation.

Article 19 — Loans

19.1 A loan is a temporary registration of a player with a second club for a defined period within the same Season.

19.2 A club may loan out not more than three players at any one time.

19.3 A club may hold not more than two loaned-in players at any one time.

19.4 A loaned player may not be fielded against the club that owns the player's contract unless the loan agreement expressly permits it and CEFA is notified at the time of filing.

19.5 The minimum loan duration is sixty days. The maximum loan duration is one Season.

19.6 A loan may be terminated early by mutual agreement of both clubs and the player, notified to CEFA not less than seven days before the next Match Window.

19.7 Loans between Elite Division clubs are prohibited after the closure of the Secondary Transfer Window.

Article 20 — Emergency Signings

20.1 An emergency signing is permitted outside a Transfer Window where a club's Roster has fallen below the minimum in Article 14 by reason of injury certified by a physician, illness certified by a physician, or termination of contract with just cause.

20.2 An emergency signing requires the prior written authorisation of the Competition Manager.

20.3 The contract of an emergency signing may be of not less than thirty days and not more than the remainder of the Season.

20.4 An emergency signing may not be fielded in the Championship Playoffs unless registered before 1 March.

20.5 A club may make not more than two emergency signings in a single Season.

20.6 The minimum remuneration in Article 16 applies to emergency signings on a pro-rata basis.

Article 21 — Termination and Just Cause

21.1 A contract may be terminated by mutual consent at any time, notified to CEFA within five days.

21.2 A player has just cause to terminate where salary is in arrears beyond the period in Article 16.7, where the club loses its licence, or where the club is relegated two divisions in a single Season.

21.3 A club has just cause to terminate where the player is sanctioned with a competition ban exceeding ninety days, where the player commits a match-manipulation offence under Article 45, or where the player is absent without authorisation for more than fifteen consecutive days.

21.4 Termination without just cause gives rise to compensation calculated as the residual value of the contract, capped at eighteen months of remuneration.

21.5 A club that terminates without just cause more than twice in a single Season is subject to a registration embargo for one Transfer Window.

Article 22 — Training Compensation

22.1 Training compensation is payable to a club that registered a player before the player's eighteenth birthday, where that player's first professional transfer occurs before the player's twenty-second birthday.

22.2 The sum payable is 6,000 credits for each complete Season of registration, up to a maximum of four Seasons.

22.3 Training compensation is not payable where the transfer is to an Open Division club or where the transferring club terminated the contract without just cause.

22.4 Claims for training compensation are filed with the Financial Control Unit within ninety days of the transfer and are determined under the procedure in Article 55.

Article 23 — Player Representation

23.1 A player may be represented by an agent registered with CEFA.

23.2 An agent may not represent both the player and either club in the same transaction.

23.3 Agent commission may not exceed ten per cent of the value of the transaction.

23.4 An agent may not hold any ownership interest in a licensed club.

23.5 Payments to unregistered agents are prohibited and constitute a financial offence under Appendix C.

Article 24 — Registration Embargo

24.1 A registration embargo prohibits a club from registering any new player, whether by transfer, loan or emergency signing, for its stated duration.

24.2 An embargo does not prevent the club from renewing the contract of a player already registered to it.

24.3 An embargo may be imposed for breach of Articles 9, 16, 21 or 23, or by decision of the Disciplinary Panel.

24.4 An embargo runs for whole Transfer Windows and is not shortened by the early lifting of the underlying breach, save by decision of the Appeals Panel.

PART IV — MATCH RULES

Article 25 — Fixture Format

- 25.1 A Fixture comprises two Legs. Leg A and Leg B are played consecutively on the same date.
- 25.2 Each Leg comprises two halves of six real-time minutes, with a half-time interval of ninety seconds.
- 25.3 The result of a Fixture is determined on aggregate goals across both Legs.
- 25.4 In the regular season a Fixture level on aggregate is recorded as a draw and no extra time is played.
- 25.5 The away-goals principle does not apply in the regular season.
- 25.6 In knockout competition a Fixture level on aggregate proceeds to extra time under Article 32.

Article 26 — Points and Standings

- 26.1 A club winning a Fixture on aggregate is awarded three points.
- 26.2 A club drawing a Fixture on aggregate is awarded one point.
- 26.3 A club losing a Fixture on aggregate is awarded no points.
- 26.4 A club that additionally wins both Legs of a Fixture is awarded one bonus point, for a maximum of four points from a single Fixture.
- 26.5 No bonus point is awarded where one Leg is won and the other drawn.
- 26.6 Standings are ordered by total points, then by the tiebreakers in Article 31.

Article 27 — Team Selection and Squad Settings

- 27.1 Each club selects its side within the Title from the club's registered squad file lodged with CEFA before the first Match Window.
- 27.2 The squad file may be amended once per Transfer Window and once by emergency amendment authorised by the Competition Manager.
- 27.3 Custom tactics may be adjusted freely between Legs but not during a Leg except during the half-time interval.
- 27.4 Formation changes during play are permitted through in-game controls only.
- 27.5 The use of any squad or player not present in the lodged squad file renders the Leg forfeit.

Article 28 — Substitutions

- 28.1 In the regular season each club may make two substitutions of controlling player per Fixture.
- 28.2 A regular-season substitution may be made only in the interval between Leg A and Leg B.

28.3 A substitution made in the regular season is final; the substituted player may not return within the same Fixture.

28.4 A club shall notify the Head Referee of a substitution not less than two minutes before the kick-off of Leg B.

28.5 An unnotified substitution is invalid and the Leg proceeds with the original Starting Player, or is forfeit if that player is unavailable.

28.6 Substitutions in knockout competition are governed by Article 39 and not by this Article.

Article 29 — Timeouts

29.1 In the regular season each club is entitled to one Timeout per Fixture, of a maximum duration of ninety seconds.

29.2 A Timeout may be requested only when the ball is out of play or at half-time.

29.3 A Timeout may not be requested in the final sixty seconds of the second half of either Leg.

29.4 The Designated Coach alone may request a Timeout, through the Tournament Client interface.

29.5 An unused regular-season Timeout does not carry over to a subsequent Fixture.

29.6 Timeouts in knockout competition are governed by Article 39.

Article 30 — Forfeiture

30.1 A forfeited Leg is recorded as a 3-0 defeat for the forfeiting club.

30.2 A forfeited Fixture is recorded as a 6-0 aggregate defeat and no bonus point is awarded to the opposing club.

30.3 Forfeiture arises on expiry of the grace period in Article 6.8, on breach of Articles 14.7, 15.5 or 27.5, or by decision of the Head Referee under Article 36.

30.4 A club that forfeits three Fixtures in a single Season is referred to the Disciplinary Panel and may be excluded from the competition.

30.5 Where a club is excluded during the regular season, all its results are expunged if the exclusion occurs before the midpoint of the season, and stand if it occurs after.

Article 31 — Regular-Season Tiebreakers

31.1 Where two or more clubs are level on points at the conclusion of the regular season, the following criteria are applied in order.

31.2 First, aggregate goal difference across all Fixtures.

31.3 Second, total goals scored across all Fixtures.

31.4 Third, the results of the Fixtures played between the clubs concerned, counted on points and then on aggregate goal difference.

31.5 Fourth, the number of Fixtures won outright, meaning Fixtures in which both Legs were won.

31.6 Fifth, the lower total of disciplinary points accrued under Appendix C.

31.7 Sixth, a single deciding Leg of six real-time minutes at a neutral venue, applicable only where the position determines a title, a playoff place or relegation.

31.8 Where the position determines nothing of the matters in 31.7, the tie is resolved by drawing of lots conducted by the Competition Manager.

PART V — KNOCKOUT COMPETITION

Article 32 — The Championship Playoffs

- 32.1 The Championship Playoffs are contested by the eight highest-placed clubs of the Elite Division regular season.
- 32.2 The bracket is seeded by final regular-season position, the first-placed club meeting the eighth, the second the seventh, the third the sixth and the fourth the fifth.
- 32.3 Quarter-finals and semi-finals are decided over a single Fixture of two Legs, played at the higher-seeded club's chosen server region.
- 32.4 The Final is decided over a Series of three Fixtures, the club winning two Fixtures being declared Champion.
- 32.5 The Final is played on LAN at a venue designated by CEFA. For Season 2026-27 the designated venue is the Arena Marítima, Valmora.
- 32.6 Where a knockout Fixture is level on aggregate after both Legs, a third Leg of six real-time minutes in total is played immediately.
- 32.7 Where the third Leg is level at its conclusion, the Fixture is decided by a penalty shoot-out conducted within the Title under the Shoot-out Protocol.
- 32.8 The Shoot-out Protocol provides for five kicks per club, followed by single kicks in sudden death, the higher-seeded club electing whether to take the first kick.
- 32.9 The away-goals principle does not apply at any stage of the Championship Playoffs.

Article 33 — Seeding and Home Advantage in the Final

- 33.1 In the Final, the higher-seeded club is Home Club for the first and third Fixtures.
- 33.2 The lower-seeded club is Home Club for the second Fixture.
- 33.3 Where both finalists hold the same regular-season points total, the seeding is determined by the criteria in Article 31 applied to the regular season alone.
- 33.4 The Champion is entitled to the Continental Shield, which remains the property of CEFA and is held by the club until fourteen days before the following Final.
- 33.5 A club winning the Final in three consecutive Seasons is entitled to retain a replica of the Continental Shield at two-thirds scale.

Article 34 — The Promotion Playoffs

- 34.1 The Promotion Playoffs are contested by the clubs placed second, third, fourth and fifth in the Open Division.
- 34.2 The semi-finals pair the second-placed club with the fifth and the third-placed club with the fourth.

34.3 Each semi-final is decided over a single Fixture of two Legs.

34.4 The Promotion Final is decided over a single Fixture of two Legs played at a neutral venue.

34.5 The winner of the Promotion Final is promoted to the Elite Division.

34.6 The loser of the Promotion Final contests the Survival Fixture under Article 5.

34.7 Where a Promotion Playoff Fixture is level on aggregate after both Legs, the higher-placed club in the regular season progresses, and no third Leg is played.

Article 35 — The Valmora Cup

35.1 The Valmora Cup is a knockout competition open to all clubs of both divisions and to eight invited clubs from affiliated associations.

35.2 The Cup is played in a single-elimination bracket over one Fixture per round until the semi-finals.

35.3 Semi-finals and the Cup Final are decided over a Series of three Fixtures.

35.4 Open Division clubs drawn against Elite Division clubs before the quarter-finals are Home Club irrespective of the draw order.

35.5 A player registered to a club after 1 February is not eligible for that club in the Cup quarter-finals or later rounds.

35.6 The Cup winner is awarded a place in the following Season's Continental Invitational.

35.7 Where a Cup Fixture is level on aggregate, the away-goals principle applies before extra time, save in the Cup Final.

Article 36 — Powers of the Head Referee

36.1 The Head Referee has authority over all matters of play from thirty minutes before the scheduled kick-off until the signature of the Match Report.

36.2 The Head Referee may order a Leg to be paused, resumed, restarted or abandoned.

36.3 The Head Referee may declare a Leg forfeit where a club obstructs the conduct of the Fixture or fails to comply with an instruction after two warnings.

36.4 Decisions of the Head Referee on matters of fact are final and are not subject to protest.

36.5 Decisions of the Head Referee on the interpretation of this Rulebook may be protested under Article 53.

36.6 The Head Referee shall file the Match Report within four hours of the conclusion of the Fixture.

Article 37 — Pauses and Interruptions

37.1 A club may pause play through the Tournament Client only for technical failure, medical necessity or a declared Timeout.

37.2 The total duration of technical pauses available to a club in a single Leg is four minutes.

37.3 Where a club exhausts its technical pause allowance, play resumes and any further technical failure affecting that club is at that club's risk.

37.4 A medical pause requires the presence of an accredited medical officer at a LAN event, or a declaration by the Designated Coach at a remote event, and may not exceed ten minutes.

37.5 An abusive pause, meaning a pause declared without genuine cause or for tactical advantage, is a disciplinary offence under Appendix C.

37.6 The Head Referee shall record the cause and duration of every pause in the Match Report.

Article 38 — Disconnection and Resumption

38.1 A disconnection occurring before the completion of the fifteenth in-game minute of a Leg results in a full restart of that Leg, with the score reset to nil.

38.2 A disconnection occurring after the completion of the fifteenth in-game minute results in resumption under the Match Resume Protocol, with the score, the elapsed time and the substitutions made preserved.

38.3 The Match Resume Protocol requires the club not responsible for the disconnection to concede possession at the point of resumption in the zone where play was interrupted.

38.4 Not more than two full restarts are permitted in a single Leg. On a third qualifying disconnection the Leg proceeds under the Match Resume Protocol irrespective of the in-game minute.

38.5 Where a club suffers three or more disconnections within a single Fixture, the Competition Manager may order the remainder of the Fixture to be replayed in full on a later date.

38.6 Repeated disconnection attributable to a club's own infrastructure is a technical offence under Appendix C after the third occurrence in a Season.

38.7 A disconnection occurring during a penalty shoot-out results in the shoot-out being restarted from the first kick.

Article 39 — Substitutions and Timeouts in Knockout Competition

39.1 In knockout competition each club may make three substitutions of controlling player per Fixture.

39.2 One of the three substitutions may be made during the half-time interval of either Leg. The remaining substitutions may be made only in the interval between Legs.

39.3 A player substituted in knockout competition may return in a later Leg of the same Fixture, but not in the same Leg.

39.4 In knockout competition each club is entitled to two Timeouts per Fixture, of a maximum duration of ninety seconds each.

39.5 Not more than one Timeout may be taken by a club in a single Leg.

39.6 In the Final only, each club is entitled to three Timeouts per Fixture, of which not more than two may be taken in a single Leg.

39.7 A Timeout may not be requested during extra time or during a penalty shoot-out.

Article 40 — Equipment and Hardware Standards

40.1 Players shall use only peripherals conforming to the CEFA Approved Peripheral List published annually by the Technical Committee.

40.2 Controllers with programmable macro functions, rapid-fire functions or continuous input functions are prohibited.

40.3 A player may use a personal controller at a LAN event subject to inspection not later than sixty minutes before kick-off.

40.4 CEFA provides the display, the platform and the network at all LAN events. Personal displays are prohibited.

40.5 The approved display standard for LAN events is 1920 by 1080 at 240 hertz with a maximum response time of one millisecond.

40.6 Headsets are permitted for audio isolation. Any communication device other than the CEFA-provided coaching channel is prohibited during play.

40.7 Failure of a personal controller during play does not entitle the player to a technical pause beyond the allowance in Article 37.2.

Article 41 — Connection Standards for Remote Fixtures

41.1 A club hosting a remote Fixture shall provide a wired connection with a sustained downstream capacity of not less than 50 megabits per second and an upstream capacity of not less than 20 megabits per second.

41.2 The maximum permitted latency to the designated server region is 35 milliseconds.

41.3 The maximum permitted packet loss is 0.5 per cent measured over the five minutes preceding kick-off.

41.4 The maximum permitted jitter is 8 milliseconds.

41.5 Each club shall run the CEFA Connection Check not more than thirty minutes and not less than ten minutes before kick-off, and shall transmit the result to the Head Referee.

41.6 A club failing the Connection Check may request one re-test within ten minutes. A second failure results in the Fixture being played on the opposing club's selected region.

41.7 Wireless connection of any component of the playing setup is prohibited, including wireless peripherals save where listed on the Approved Peripheral List as exempt.

PART VI — GAME BUILD AND TECHNICAL GOVERNANCE

Article 42 — The Competition Build

- 42.1 Competitive play takes place exclusively on the Competition Build, being the version of the Title designated by the Technical Committee.
- 42.2 The Competition Build for the opening Match Window of Season 2026-27 is version 26.2.1.
- 42.3 The Competition Build is distributed through the Tournament Client and may not be modified.
- 42.4 The use of any file replacement, overlay, texture modification or memory-resident tool affecting the Title is prohibited.
- 42.5 Streaming software, voice communication software and hardware monitoring software are permitted where listed in the Approved Software List.

Article 43 — Patch Adoption

- 43.1 Where the publisher releases a new version of the Title, the Technical Committee shall determine within seventy-two hours whether it is adopted as the Competition Build.
- 43.2 A new version adopted during the regular season takes effect from the start of the second Match Window following the decision.
- 43.3 A Patch Freeze operates in the ten days preceding the first Fixture of the Championship Playoffs, during which no new version may be adopted.
- 43.4 A Patch Freeze operates in the fourteen days preceding the Final, during which no new version may be adopted for any reason.
- 43.5 Notwithstanding 43.3 and 43.4, the Technical Committee may adopt an Emergency Hotfix where a defect renders competition impossible or confers a decisive and unintended advantage. An Emergency Hotfix requires the unanimous decision of the three members of the Technical Committee.
- 43.6 Clubs shall be given not less than four days' notice of any change to the Competition Build, save in the case of an Emergency Hotfix, where the notice period is twenty-four hours.
- 43.7 A club may submit a written observation on a proposed build change within forty-eight hours of notification. Observations are advisory only.

Article 44 — Defects and Exploits

- 44.1 An exploit is any use of unintended software behaviour to obtain a sporting advantage.
- 44.2 The Technical Committee maintains and publishes the Register of Prohibited Behaviours, which is binding from the date of publication.
- 44.3 The deliberate use of a behaviour listed in the Register is a serious offence under Appendix C and carries a minimum sanction of a four-Fixture ban.

- 44.4 A club discovering a defect shall report it to the Technical Committee within twenty-four hours and shall not exploit it in the interim.
- 44.5 A club that reports a previously unknown defect and is found to have exploited it before reporting is sanctioned as if it had not reported.
- 44.6 Where an exploit materially affects the result of a Leg and is identified before the Match Report is signed, the Head Referee shall order the Leg replayed.
- 44.7 Where an exploit is identified after the Match Report is signed, the result stands and the matter proceeds as a disciplinary case.

PART VII — CONDUCT, INTEGRITY AND DISCIPLINE

Article 45 — Match Manipulation

- 45.1 Any attempt to influence the course or result of a Fixture by means contrary to sporting ethics is prohibited.
- 45.2 The prohibition extends to players, staff, officers, owners, agents and any person acting on their behalf.
- 45.3 The minimum sanction for a proven offence of match manipulation is a five-year ban from all CEFA activity.
- 45.4 The minimum sanction for a club whose officer is proven to have participated is relegation and a fine of 250,000 credits.
- 45.5 Any person subject to this Rulebook who becomes aware of an approach to manipulate a Fixture shall report it to the Integrity Unit within twenty-four hours.
- 45.6 Failure to report under 45.5 carries a ban of not less than six months.
- 45.7 A person who reports an approach in good faith is protected from any sanction arising from the disclosure and from any retaliation by a club.

Article 46 — Betting

- 46.1 Players, staff and officers may not place any wager on any CEFA competition, whether directly or through a third party.
- 46.2 The prohibition applies irrespective of the club or division concerned.
- 46.3 Players, staff and officers may not accept any sponsorship, gift or benefit from a betting operator in a personal capacity.
- 46.4 A club may enter into a sponsorship agreement with a licensed betting operator subject to Article 59.
- 46.5 A breach of 46.1 carries a ban of not less than twelve months and a fine of not less than 10,000 credits.

Article 47 — Confidential Information

- 47.1 Non-public information concerning team selection, player fitness, contractual matters or tactical preparation is confidential.
- 47.2 No person may disclose confidential information to any party with a betting interest.
- 47.3 Disclosure of team selection before the publication of the Matchsheet is a disciplinary offence.
- 47.4 The Integrity Unit may require the production of communications records where there are reasonable grounds to suspect a breach of this Article.

Article 48 — Conduct of Players

- 48.1 Players shall conduct themselves with respect towards opponents, officials, spectators and the public.
- 48.2 Insulting, discriminatory or threatening language is prohibited in all competition contexts, including in-game chat, official broadcasts, press activity and public social media accounts.
- 48.3 Discriminatory conduct on grounds of origin, ethnicity, nationality, religion, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation or disability carries a minimum sanction of a six-Fixture ban.
- 48.4 A second proven offence under 48.3 within twenty-four months carries a minimum sanction of a two-year ban.
- 48.5 Deliberate damage to equipment provided by CEFA carries a fine and liability for the full replacement cost.
- 48.6 A player who leaves the playing position without authorisation during a Leg other than during a declared pause commits a disciplinary offence.

Article 49 — Conduct of Clubs

- 49.1 A club is responsible for the conduct of its players, staff, officers and accredited guests.
- 49.2 A club is responsible for the conduct of its supporters at any LAN event at which it participates.
- 49.3 A club shall take reasonable measures to prevent discriminatory conduct within its organisation and shall cooperate with any investigation.
- 49.4 A club that fails to cooperate with an investigation of the Integrity Unit is liable to a fine of not less than 15,000 credits.
- 49.5 Public criticism of match officials by a club officer that impugns their integrity carries a fine and may carry a stadium or broadcast ban for the officer concerned.

Article 50 — Disciplinary Points

- 50.1 Disciplinary points are accrued by clubs for offences committed by their players and staff during Fixtures.
- 50.2 A caution recorded within the Title carries one disciplinary point.
- 50.3 A dismissal recorded within the Title carries three disciplinary points.
- 50.4 An abusive pause under Article 37.5 carries four disciplinary points.
- 50.5 A failure of media obligations under Article 57 carries two disciplinary points.
- 50.6 Disciplinary points are used as the fifth tiebreaker under Article 31.6 and are reset at the conclusion of each regular season.
- 50.7 A club accruing forty or more disciplinary points in a single regular season is fined 20,000 credits and referred to the Disciplinary Panel.

Article 51 — Bans and Their Service

51.1 A ban expressed in Fixtures is served in the next Fixtures for which the player would otherwise be eligible, in the same competition in which the offence occurred.

51.2 A ban expressed in time runs continuously and is not suspended by the close season.

51.3 A ban imposed in the Elite Division is served in any CEFA competition.

51.4 A ban arising from an offence in the Valmora Cup is served in the Valmora Cup, save where the ban exceeds four Fixtures, in which case the excess is served in the League.

51.5 An unserved ban transfers with the player on a transfer to another club.

51.6 A ban may not be converted into a fine.

Article 52 — The Disciplinary Panel

52.1 The Disciplinary Panel comprises five members appointed by the CEFA Board for terms of three years.

52.2 A case is heard by a chamber of three members, one of whom shall hold a legal qualification.

52.3 The Panel may impose warnings, fines, disciplinary points, bans, registration embargoes, deduction of points, exclusion from a competition and relegation.

52.4 The Panel shall issue its decision within fourteen days of the conclusion of the hearing, with written reasons.

52.5 The Panel may impose a provisional suspension pending the conclusion of proceedings where the offence alleged carries a minimum sanction exceeding six months.

52.6 Proceedings before the Panel are confidential until the decision becomes final.

PART VIII — PROTESTS AND APPEALS

Article 53 — Protests

- 53.1 A club may protest the conduct of a Fixture on grounds of a misapplication of this Rulebook.
- 53.2 A protest shall be filed by the Compliance Officer within two hours of the conclusion of the Fixture.
- 53.3 A protest shall state the provision alleged to have been misapplied and the remedy sought.
- 53.4 A protest is accompanied by a deposit of 1,000 credits, refunded if the protest succeeds.
- 53.5 A protest against a decision of fact by the Head Referee is inadmissible.
- 53.6 The Competition Manager decides a protest within twenty-four hours.

Article 54 — Appeals

- 54.1 A decision of the Disciplinary Panel or of the Competition Manager may be appealed to the Appeals Panel.
- 54.2 An appeal shall be filed within forty-eight hours of notification of the reasoned decision.
- 54.3 An appeal is accompanied by a deposit of 3,000 credits, refunded if the appeal succeeds in whole or in part.
- 54.4 The Appeals Panel comprises three members, none of whom may have sat in the first instance.
- 54.5 The Appeals Panel reviews both facts and law and may increase, reduce, confirm or annul the sanction.
- 54.6 The Appeals Panel shall decide within ten days of the filing of the appeal, save in cases affecting the composition of a competition, where it shall decide within four days.
- 54.7 An appeal does not suspend the execution of the decision unless the Appeals Panel so orders on application.

Article 55 — Financial Disputes

- 55.1 Disputes between clubs, or between a club and a player, concerning sums payable under this Rulebook are determined by the Financial Control Unit.
- 55.2 A claim is filed within ninety days of the sum falling due.
- 55.3 The Financial Control Unit decides on the documents unless it convenes a hearing on its own motion.
- 55.4 A decision of the Financial Control Unit may be appealed to the Appeals Panel under Article 54.
- 55.5 A club that fails to satisfy a final financial decision within thirty days incurs a registration embargo and a deduction of three points.

Article 56 — Arbitration

56.1 A final decision of the Appeals Panel may be referred to the Continental Court of Esports Arbitration within twenty-one days.

56.2 Recourse to ordinary courts is excluded save where mandatory law provides otherwise.

56.3 The seat of arbitration is Valmora and the language of proceedings is English.

PART IX — MEDIA, BROADCASTING AND COMMERCIAL

Article 57 — Media Obligations

- 57.1 The Starting Player of each club and the Designated Coach shall be available to the official broadcaster for a pre-Fixture interview of not more than three minutes, conducted not less than fifteen minutes before kick-off.
- 57.2 Each club shall make at least one player available for post-Fixture interview within twenty minutes of the conclusion of the Fixture.
- 57.3 A club shall attend the post-Fixture press conference where one is scheduled, within forty minutes of the conclusion of the Fixture.
- 57.4 Failure to fulfil an obligation under this Article carries two disciplinary points and a fine of 2,000 credits for a first offence.
- 57.5 A second failure in the same Season carries a fine of 5,000 credits.
- 57.6 A club may be excused an obligation under this Article only by the Competition Manager and only on grounds of medical necessity.

Article 58 — Broadcasting Rights

- 58.1 All broadcasting rights in CEFA competitions vest in CEFA.
- 58.2 A club may stream its own player perspective of a Fixture subject to a delay of not less than one hundred and twenty seconds.
- 58.3 A club may not stream the official broadcast production or any part of it.
- 58.4 A club may publish highlight material of its own Fixtures not exceeding ninety seconds in total per Fixture, from one hour after its conclusion.
- 58.5 A player may stream personal practice sessions at any time, save in the twenty-four hours preceding a Fixture in the Championship Playoffs.
- 58.6 CEFA distributes broadcast revenue under Article 61.

Article 59 — Sponsorship and Branding

- 59.1 A club may carry sponsorship on its competition jersey subject to the placement standards published by CEFA.
- 59.2 The maximum area of the principal chest sponsor is 200 square centimetres.
- 59.3 The club crest shall occupy a position on the left chest and shall not be obscured.
- 59.4 Sponsorship by producers of tobacco, by unlicensed betting operators, by cryptocurrency exchanges not licensed in a CEFA territory, and by any competitor of a CEFA title partner in the same product category is prohibited.

59.5 A club shall submit its jersey design for approval not later than 15 August. CEFA shall decide within ten days.

59.6 Branding on peripherals is limited to the manufacturer's own marks.

Article 60 — Player Image Rights

60.1 A player grants CEFA a non-exclusive licence to use the player's image in connection with the promotion of CEFA competitions.

60.2 The licence does not extend to the endorsement of third-party products without the player's specific consent.

60.3 A club may not require a player to assign image rights for a period exceeding the term of the playing contract.

60.4 Group image material produced by CEFA may be used by clubs for their own non-commercial purposes without further consent.

PART X — FINANCE AND PRIZES

Article 61 — Distribution of Broadcast Revenue

- 61.1 Net broadcast revenue of the Elite Division is distributed as to fifty per cent in equal shares among the sixteen clubs, as to thirty per cent by final regular-season position, and as to twenty per cent by audience share attributable to each club.
- 61.2 Net broadcast revenue of the Open Division is distributed as to seventy per cent in equal shares and as to thirty per cent by final regular-season position.
- 61.3 Distribution is made in two instalments, in February and in July.
- 61.4 A club excluded from the competition forfeits all undistributed revenue for that Season.
- 61.5 A club under a registration embargo continues to receive distribution unless the Disciplinary Panel orders otherwise.

Article 62 — Licence Deposit

- 62.1 Each Elite Division club lodges a Licence Deposit of 60,000 credits before the first Match Window.
- 62.2 The Deposit is returned within sixty days of the conclusion of the Season, less any deduction for unpaid fines.
- 62.3 A club relegated under Article 5 forfeits forty per cent of the Deposit.
- 62.4 A club excluded under Article 30.4 forfeits the Deposit in full.
- 62.5 The Open Division Licence Deposit is 15,000 credits and is subject to the same conditions save that no forfeiture arises on relegation.

Article 63 — Fines and Payment

- 63.1 Fines are payable within thirty days of the decision becoming final.
- 63.2 A fine unpaid after thirty days attracts a surcharge of ten per cent and, after sixty days, a deduction of one point.
- 63.3 A fine imposed on a player may be deducted from remuneration only with the player's written consent.
- 63.4 Where a club pays a fine imposed on its player, the club remains entitled to recover it from the player under the contract.
- 63.5 Fines collected by CEFA are allocated to the Academy Development Fund.

PART XI — ACADEMY AND DEVELOPMENT COMPETITIONS

Article 64 — The Academy League

- 64.1 The Academy League is a competition for players who have not reached the age of nineteen on the first day of the Season.
- 64.2 Participation is compulsory for every Elite Division club and optional for Open Division clubs.
- 64.3 The Academy League comprises a single round-robin in which each participating club plays every other club once.
- 64.4 Academy League Fixtures comprise two Legs and are resolved on aggregate, as in the senior competition.
- 64.5 Academy League Fixtures are played on Wednesdays, outside the senior Match Window.
- 64.6 The Academy League regular season of Season 2026-27 begins on 30 September 2026 and concludes on 10 March 2027.
- 64.7 The Academy League champion is the club placed first at the conclusion of the round-robin. No playoffs are held.

Article 65 — Academy Registration

- 65.1 An academy player is registered in the same Registration System as a senior player and is subject to Article 13.
- 65.2 A club may register not more than sixteen academy players at any one time.
- 65.3 An academy player who has appeared in six or more senior Fixtures in a Season may not thereafter be fielded in the Academy League in that Season.
- 65.4 An academy player may be fielded in the senior competition without any further registration step, subject to the age restrictions in Article 15.
- 65.5 A club shall designate an Academy Director, who may not simultaneously hold the position of head coach of the senior side.

Article 66 — Academy Standards

- 66.1 A club shall provide each academy player with a minimum of six hours of structured coaching per week outside competition.
- 66.2 A club shall provide each academy player under the age of eighteen with evidence of enrolment in secondary or equivalent education, renewed each Season.
- 66.3 A club shall not require an academy player under the age of eighteen to practise for more than twenty-five hours in any period of seven consecutive days.

66.4 A club shall appoint a welfare officer responsible for academy players, independent of the coaching staff.

66.5 CEFA may audit compliance with this Article on fourteen days' notice and may require the production of training records.

66.6 A club found in breach of 66.3 is fined 12,000 credits and, on a second breach within twenty-four months, loses one academy registration slot for the following Season.

Article 67 — The Academy Development Fund

67.1 The Academy Development Fund is administered by a board of five members, of whom two are appointed by the clubs.

67.2 The Fund is financed by collected fines under Article 63.5, by a levy of two per cent on transfer compensation exceeding 100,000 credits, and by any grant made by CEFA.

67.3 The Fund makes annual grants to clubs for coaching qualifications, welfare provision and equipment.

67.4 A club under a registration embargo is not eligible for a grant in the Season in which the embargo is imposed.

67.5 The Fund publishes audited accounts within ninety days of the conclusion of each Season.

Article 68 — The Development Draft

68.1 The Development Draft is held annually on the second Saturday of June.

68.2 Players eligible for the Draft are those aged between fifteen and eighteen who have completed the CEFA Combine and who are not under contract to any licensed club.

68.3 The draft order is the reverse of the final Elite Division regular-season standings, followed by the Open Division in reverse order.

68.4 The Draft comprises two rounds. A club may trade its selection in either round for a selection in a future Draft or for transfer compensation.

68.5 A club may not trade more than two future selections in any single Draft.

68.6 A drafted player who does not sign within sixty days of the Draft re-enters the following Draft and the selecting club receives no compensation.

68.7 The minimum contract offered to a drafted player is twelve months at the Open Division minimum remuneration, irrespective of the division of the selecting club.

Article 69 — Dual Registration

69.1 A dual registration permits an academy player to be registered simultaneously with an Elite Division club and with an Open Division club for the purposes of the Open Division competition only.

69.2 A dual registration requires the written agreement of both clubs and of the player.

69.3 A club may hold not more than three dual-registered players at any one time.

69.4 A dual-registered player may not be fielded against the Elite Division club holding the player's contract.

69.5 A dual registration terminates automatically at the close of the Secondary Transfer Window unless expressly renewed.

69.6 A dual-registered player counts against the Roster maximum of the Open Division club but not against that of the Elite Division club.

APPENDIX A — PRIZE MONEY AND FINANCIAL SCHEDULES

A.1 Elite Division Prize Pool

The total Elite Division prize pool for Season 2026-27 is 4,500,000 credits, allocated as set out below. Regular-season prize money is paid on the basis of final position irrespective of subsequent playoff performance.

Final regular-season position	Prize (credits)
1st	420,000
2nd	340,000
3rd	290,000
4th	250,000
5th	215,000
6th	185,000
7th	160,000
8th	140,000
9th	120,000
10th	105,000
11th	95,000
12th	85,000
13th	75,000
14th	65,000
15th	50,000
16th	40,000

A.2 Championship Playoff Prize Money

Playoff prize money is additional to regular-season prize money and is paid within forty-five days of the Final.

Stage reached	Prize (credits)
Champion	760,000
Runner-up	420,000
Losing semi-finalist	210,000
Losing quarter-finalist	95,000

A.3 Open Division Prize Pool

The total Open Division prize pool for Season 2026-27 is 900,000 credits.

Final regular-season position	Prize (credits)
1st	140,000
2nd	105,000
3rd	85,000
4th	70,000
5th	60,000
6th to 10th	40,000 each
11th to 15th	26,000 each
16th to 20th	15,000 each

A.4 Valmora Cup Prize Money

Stage reached	Prize (credits)
Cup Winner	300,000
Cup Runner-up	150,000
Losing semi-finalist	70,000
Losing quarter-finalist	35,000
Losing in round of sixteen	18,000

A.5 Individual Award Prizes

Award	Prize (credits)
Player of the Season	60,000
Golden Boot	40,000
Academy Player of the Season	30,000
Coach of the Season	25,000
Save of the Season	8,000
Goal of the Season	12,000

APPENDIX B — AWARDS, RECORDS AND TIEBREAKERS

B.1 Player of the Season

- B.1.1 The Player of the Season is elected by a panel comprising the sixteen Elite Division head coaches, twenty accredited journalists and a public vote weighted at twenty per cent of the total.
- B.1.2 A coach may not vote for a player registered to that coach's own club.
- B.1.3 A player must have appeared in at least twenty regular-season Fixtures to be eligible.
- B.1.4 Where two players are level in the final count, the award is shared and each receives the full prize.

B.2 The Golden Boot

- B.2.1 The Golden Boot is awarded to the player scoring the greatest number of goals across the Elite Division regular season.
- B.2.2 Goals scored in the Championship Playoffs, in the Valmora Cup and in the Survival Fixture do not count towards the Golden Boot.
- B.2.3 Own goals conceded by an opponent do not count towards any player's total.
- B.2.4 Where two or more players are level on goals, the award is decided by the following criteria in order: first, the fewer cautions recorded within the Title across the regular season; second, the fewer Legs played; third, the greater number of goals scored away from home; fourth, the award is shared.
- B.2.5 Goals scored in a Leg that is subsequently declared forfeit are struck from the player's total.

B.3 Academy Player of the Season

- B.3.1 The award is open to players who have not reached the age of nineteen on the first day of the Season.
- B.3.2 The winner is selected by the CEFA Technical Committee on the recommendation of the Academy Development Fund board.
- B.3.3 A player may win the Academy Player of the Season award not more than twice.

B.4 League Records

- B.4.1 The record for the greatest number of points accumulated in an Elite Division regular season is 79, set by Ríos Atlético in Season 2023-24.
- B.4.2 The record for the greatest number of goals scored by a club in an Elite Division regular season is 214, set by Ciudad Oriente in Season 2024-25.

B.4.3 The record for the greatest number of goals scored by a player in an Elite Division regular season is 61, set by Nahuel Ferrada of Puerto Halcón in Season 2022-23.

B.4.4 The record for the longest unbeaten run is 24 Fixtures, set by Ríos Atlético between October 2023 and March 2024.

B.4.5 The record aggregate margin in a single Fixture is thirteen goals, recorded when Ciudad Oriente defeated Monte Azur by an aggregate of 14-1 in February 2025.

B.4.6 The youngest player to appear in an Elite Division Fixture is Iker Salvatierra, aged sixteen years and nineteen days, for Delta Valmora in September 2025.

B.4.7 Three clubs have won the Continental Shield more than once: Ríos Atlético on four occasions, Puerto Halcón on three occasions and Ciudad Oriente on two occasions.

B.5 Roll of Honour

Season	Champion	Runner-up	Valmora Cup Winner
2019-20	Puerto Halcón	Ríos Atlético	Ciudad Oriente
2020-21	Ríos Atlético	Ciudad Oriente	Puerto Halcón
2021-22	Puerto Halcón	Delta Valmora	Ríos Atlético
2022-23	Ríos Atlético	Puerto Halcón	Norte Ferroviario
2023-24	Ríos Atlético	Ciudad Oriente	Ciudad Oriente
2024-25	Ciudad Oriente	Monte Azur	Delta Valmora
2025-26	Ríos Atlético	Puerto Halcón	Puerto Halcón

APPENDIX C — SCHEDULE OF OFFENCES AND SANCTIONS

C.1 Club Offences

The sanctions below are standard sanctions. The Disciplinary Panel may depart from them where aggravating or mitigating circumstances are established, and shall state its reasons for doing so.

Offence	Standard fine (credits)	Additional sanction
Late submission of Matchsheet	1,500	None
False statement on Matchsheet	12,000	Forfeiture of the Fixture
Failure to attend press conference	2,000	Two disciplinary points
Failure of Connection Check, third occurrence in a Season	4,000	None
Repeated disconnection, fourth occurrence in a Season	7,500	None
Financial Reserve below threshold	18,000	Registration embargo, one Window
Payment to unregistered agent	25,000	Registration embargo, one Window
Fielding an ineligible player	30,000	Forfeiture and deduction of three points
Failure to cooperate with the Integrity Unit	15,000	Referral to the Disciplinary Panel
Unauthorised streaming of official production	9,000	None
Sponsorship in a prohibited category	22,000	Order to remove branding
Forty or more disciplinary points in a Season	20,000	Referral to the Disciplinary Panel
Officer participation in match manipulation	250,000	Relegation

C.2 Player and Staff Offences

Offence	Standard fine (credits)	Standard ban
Dissent towards a match official	600	None
Insulting language towards an opponent	1,800	One Fixture
Abusive pause	2,500	One Fixture
Leaving the playing position without authorisation	1,200	None

Offence	Standard fine (credits)	Standard ban
Deliberate damage to CEFA equipment	3,000 plus replacement cost	Two Fixtures
Discriminatory conduct, first offence	9,000	Six Fixtures
Discriminatory conduct, second offence within 24 months	20,000	Two years
Use of a prohibited peripheral	6,000	Four Fixtures
Use of a behaviour in the Register of Prohibited Behaviours	8,000	Four Fixtures
Placing a wager on a CEFA competition	10,000	Twelve months
Failure to report an approach to manipulate	5,000	Six months
Match manipulation	50,000	Five years

C.3 Disciplinary Point Values

Event	Disciplinary points
Caution recorded within the Title	1
Dismissal recorded within the Title	3
Abusive pause	4
Failure of media obligations	2
Dissent towards a match official	2
Late arrival in the Tournament Client lobby	1

APPENDIX D — CLUB DIRECTORY, ELITE DIVISION

D.1 Ríos Atlético

Founded in 2016 in the city of Ríos Bajos, Ríos Atlético is the most decorated club in the League with four Continental Shields. The club plays in dark green and white and holds its LAN engagements at the Pabellón del Río, a venue with a seated capacity of 3,400. Its head coach is Marcela Ondarza, appointed in 2022. The club operates the largest academy in the League with fourteen players under contract below the age of nineteen. Ríos Atlético holds the League records for points in a season and for the longest unbeaten run.

D.2 Puerto Halcón

Founded in 2017 in the port city of Puerto Halcón, the club has won three Continental Shields and two Valmora Cups. Its colours are navy blue and amber. The club's LAN venue is the Sala Marítima, capacity 2,100. Its head coach is Tobias Reinhardt, appointed in 2024 after four seasons at Norte Ferroviario. The club is notable for having fielded the same Starting Player in ninety-one consecutive Fixtures between 2021 and 2024.

D.3 Ciudad Oriente

Founded in 2015, Ciudad Oriente is the oldest club in the League and the only one constituted as a supporter-owned association. The club plays in red and black and holds its LAN engagements at the Auditorio Oriente, capacity 4,800, the largest venue in the League. Its head coach is Paula Vergara, appointed in 2025. The club holds the record for goals scored in a season and won the Continental Shield in 2024-25.

D.4 Delta Valmora

Founded in 2019 as the first club licensed in the capital, Delta Valmora plays in sky blue and white at the Complejo Delta, capacity 1,900. Its head coach is Andrés Quiroga, appointed in 2023. The club has never won the Continental Shield but reached the Final in Season 2021-22 and won the Valmora Cup in 2024-25. Delta Valmora registered the youngest player ever to appear in the Elite Division.

D.5 Monte Azur

Founded in 2018 in the mountain city of Monte Azur, the club plays in azure and silver at the Sala Altura, capacity 1,500, the highest-altitude venue in the League at 2,840 metres above sea level. Its head coach is Ignacio Beltrán, appointed in 2026. The club finished runner-up in Season 2024-25, its best result.

D.6 Norte Ferroviario

Founded in 2016 by employees of the northern railway company, Norte Ferroviario plays in maroon and cream at the Depósito Norte, a converted railway shed with a capacity of 2,600. Its head coach is Lucía Ferrer, appointed in 2024. The club won the Valmora Cup in Season

2022-23 and has never finished below eleventh in the Elite Division.

D.7 Costa Lumina

Founded in 2020, Costa Lumina is the youngest club in the Elite Division and plays in turquoise and white at the Pabellón Lumina, capacity 1,700. Its head coach is Rafael Do Santos, appointed in 2025. The club was promoted from the Open Division in 2024 and finished seventh in its first Elite season.

D.8 Sierra Bravo

Founded in 2017, Sierra Bravo plays in black and gold at the Recinto Bravo, capacity 2,200. Its head coach is Verónica Castell, appointed in 2021, making her the longest-serving head coach in the League. The club is known for developing academy players and has sold more players to other Elite clubs than any other club in the League.

D.9 Laguna Central

Founded in 2018, Laguna Central plays in white and violet at the Centro Laguna, capacity 1,400, the smallest venue in the Elite Division. Its head coach is Emilio Nardi, appointed in 2026. The club has twice avoided relegation through the Survival Fixture, in 2022 and in 2025.

D.10 Real Ánsar

Founded in 2016, Real Ánsar plays in crimson at the Palacio Ánsar, capacity 3,100. Its head coach is Sofía Urrutia, appointed in 2024. The club holds the record for the fewest goals conceded in an Elite Division regular season, with thirty-eight in Season 2023-24.

D.11 Ferro Bahía

Founded in 2019, Ferro Bahía plays in orange and navy at the Muelle Bahía, capacity 2,000. Its head coach is Damián Roca, appointed in 2025. The club was promoted in 2023 and has finished tenth, ninth and eighth in successive seasons.

D.12 Alto Paraná

Founded in 2017, Alto Paraná plays in green and yellow at the Estadio Virtual Paraná, capacity 2,700. Its head coach is Nicolás Ibáñez, appointed in 2023. The club holds the record for the greatest number of Fixtures won outright in a single season, with nineteen in Season 2024-25.

D.13 Unión Salta

Founded in 2018, Unión Salta plays in white and red at the Sala Unión, capacity 1,800. Its head coach is Camila Peredo, appointed in 2026. The club has the youngest average roster age in the Elite Division at nineteen years and four months.

D.14 Vientos del Sur

Founded in 2020, Vientos del Sur plays in grey and light blue at the Pabellón Austral, capacity 1,600. Its head coach is Joaquín Medrano, appointed in 2025. The club is the only Elite Division club to have been promoted directly as Open Division champion in its first season of existence.

D.15 Cruz del Llano

Founded in 2016, Cruz del Llano plays in purple and white at the Centro Llano, capacity 2,400. Its head coach is Beatriz Salvatierra, appointed in 2022. The club has never qualified for the Championship Playoffs despite eight seasons in the Elite Division.

D.16 Atlántico Dorado

Founded in 2019, Atlántico Dorado plays in gold and navy at the Arena Dorada, capacity 2,900. Its head coach is Federico Lantz, appointed in 2024. The club was the subject of the first registration embargo imposed under Article 24, for a breach of the Financial Reserve requirement in Season 2023-24.

APPENDIX E — COMPETITION BUILD HISTORY

E.1 Scope of this Appendix

E.1.1 This Appendix records the versions of the Title adopted as the Competition Build and summarises the balance changes relevant to competitive play. It is published for reference and does not create obligations.

E.1.2 Where a change described in this Appendix conflicts with the publisher's own patch notes, the publisher's notes prevail as to software behaviour and this Appendix prevails as to the date of adoption.

E.2 Version 25.4.0, adopted 4 March 2026

Through-ball assistance reduced by eight per cent at all assistance settings. Goalkeeper reaction time on close-range shots increased by forty milliseconds. Stamina drain for sustained sprinting increased by twelve per cent. The defensive pressing trigger radius reduced from 9.0 to 8.2 metres. This was the final build of Season 2025-26.

E.3 Version 26.0.0, adopted 20 July 2026

The annual edition release. Rebuilt physics for aerial duels. New momentum model reducing the effectiveness of instantaneous direction changes by approximately fifteen per cent. Introduction of the Tactical Presets system with six slots per squad. Goalkeeper distribution accuracy at long range reduced by eleven per cent. First-time finishing accuracy from outside the penalty area reduced by nine per cent.

E.4 Version 26.1.0, adopted 8 August 2026

Corner kick delivery accuracy reduced by six per cent following the high conversion rates observed in pre-season. Defensive line height adjustment made available during play through the tactical wheel. Fatigue recovery between Legs standardised at seventy-five per cent of maximum for all squads. Two exploits involving the Tactical Presets system were closed.

E.5 Version 26.2.0, adopted 26 August 2026

Referee strictness normalised across all difficulty levels. Sliding tackle success rate from behind reduced by fourteen per cent. Player switching responsiveness improved by twenty milliseconds. The through-ball assistance reduction of version 25.4.0 was partially reverted, restoring four of the eight per cent removed.

E.6 Version 26.2.1, adopted 2 September 2026

A stability hotfix addressing a client crash occurring when a Timeout was requested during a goal celebration. No balance changes. This is the Competition Build for the opening Match Window of Season 2026-27.

E.7 Version 26.3.0, projected for review in November 2026

The publisher has announced a mid-season update expected to address goalkeeper positioning on crosses and the effectiveness of the high defensive line. The Technical Committee will determine adoption under Article 43 within seventy-two hours of release. Clubs are reminded that observations filed under Article 43.7 are advisory only.

APPENDIX F — GLOSSARY AND INDEX OF TERMS

F.1 Glossary

Academy Development Fund: the fund to which collected fines are allocated under Article 63.5.

Academy Player: a registered player who has not reached the age of nineteen on the first day of the Season.

Aggregate: the combined goal total of both Legs of a Fixture.

Appeals Panel: the second-instance judicial body, comprising three members under Article 54.4.

Approved Peripheral List: the annual publication of the Technical Committee listing permitted controllers and peripherals.

Approved Software List: the publication listing software permitted to run concurrently with the Competition Build.

Away Club: the club named second in the published calendar for a Fixture.

Bonus point: the single additional point awarded under Article 26.4 for winning both Legs of a Fixture.

Caution: a booking recorded within the Title, carrying one disciplinary point.

Competition Build: the version of the Title designated for competitive play.

Competition Manager: the CEFA officer with operational authority over a Match Window.

Compliance Officer: the club officer who is the sole channel for formal communication with CEFA.

Connection Check: the pre-Fixture test of latency, packet loss and jitter required by Article 41.5.

Continental Player: a player holding citizenship of a territory affiliated to CEFA.

Continental Shield: the trophy awarded to the Champion.

Credit: the accounting unit of CEFA schedules, fixed at one United States dollar.

Designated Coach: the staff member entitled to occupy the coaching position and request a Timeout.

Disciplinary points: points accrued by clubs for offences, used as the fifth regular-season tiebreaker.

Dismissal: a sending-off recorded within the Title, carrying three disciplinary points.

Elite Division: the first tier of the League, comprising sixteen clubs.

Emergency Hotfix: a build change adopted outside the ordinary procedure under Article 43.5.

Emergency signing: a registration outside a Transfer Window permitted under Article 20.

Financial Control Unit: the CEFA body determining financial disputes under Article 55.

Financial Reserve: the segregated sum each club must maintain under Article 9.

Fixture: the complete encounter between two clubs on a scheduled date, comprising two Legs.

Forfeiture: the loss of a Leg or Fixture by operation of Article 30.

Game: a single completed instance of play, comprising two halves of six real-time minutes.

Golden Boot: the award to the leading regular-season goalscorer.

Grace period: the eight minutes allowed under Article 6.8 before forfeiture arises.

Head Referee: the official appointed to supervise a Fixture.

Home Club: the club named first in the published calendar for a Fixture.

Integrity Unit: the CEFA body responsible for investigating manipulation and betting offences.

Leg: a synonym of Game in the context of a Fixture.

Licence Deposit: the sum lodged under Article 62.

Loan: a temporary registration with a second club under Article 19.

Match Report: the document filed by the Head Referee within four hours of a Fixture.

Match Resume Protocol: the procedure for resuming a Leg after a late disconnection.

Match Window: the period in which the Fixtures of a Round are played.

Matchsheet: the pre-Fixture document naming the Starting Player, Substitutes and Designated Coach.

Open Division: the second tier of the League, comprising twenty clubs.

Overseas Player: a player who is not a Continental Player.

Patch Freeze: the period before the Championship Playoffs and the Final in which no new build may be adopted.

Promotion Playoffs: the competition among the Open Division clubs placed second to fifth.

Protest: a challenge to the conduct of a Fixture filed under Article 53.

Register of Prohibited Behaviours: the binding list of exploits maintained by the Technical Committee.

Registration embargo: the prohibition on registering new players under Article 24.

Round: the complete set of Fixtures scheduled within one Match Window.

Series: a sequence of Fixtures between the same clubs within a knockout round.

Shoot-out Protocol: the penalty procedure applied under Article 32.7.

Starting Player: the player controlling the club's side at the kick-off of Leg A.

Survival Fixture: the Fixture under Article 5 between the fourteenth-placed Elite club and the losing Promotion finalist.

Technical Committee: the CEFA body responsible for build adoption and technical standards.

Timeout: the interruption of play requested by the Designated Coach under Article 29 or Article 39.

Title: the video game Total Football 26 in its CEFA-distributed build.

Tournament Client: the CEFA software distribution, version 9.x, through which matches are launched.

Training compensation: the sum payable under Article 22 to a club that registered a player before the age of eighteen.

Transfer Window: the period in which registrations may ordinarily be filed.

Valmora Cup: the knockout competition open to both divisions and eight invited clubs.

Valmora time: Coordinated Universal Time minus four hours, without seasonal adjustment.

APPENDIX G — SEASON 2026-27 ELITE DIVISION CALENDAR

G.1 Regular-Season Rounds

Each Round is played within the Match Window opening on the date stated. Rounds 1 to 15 constitute the first half of the season and Rounds 16 to 30 the second half. The midpoint of the regular season for the purposes of Article 30.5 falls at the conclusion of Round 15.

Round	Match Window opens	Notes
1	12 September 2026	Opening Round
2	19 September 2026	
3	26 September 2026	
4	3 October 2026	
5	10 October 2026	
6	17 October 2026	Valmora Cup first round in midweek
7	24 October 2026	
8	31 October 2026	
9	14 November 2026	Resumes after the international break
10	21 November 2026	
11	28 November 2026	
12	5 December 2026	
13	12 December 2026	
14	19 December 2026	Final Round before the winter recess
15	9 January 2027	Secondary Transfer Window closes 14 January
16	16 January 2027	
17	23 January 2027	
18	30 January 2027	
19	6 February 2027	Valmora Cup round of sixteen in midweek
20	13 February 2027	
21	20 February 2027	
22	27 February 2027	
23	6 March 2027	

Round	Match Window opens	Notes
24	13 March 2027	
25	20 March 2027	
26	27 March 2027	Final Round of the regular season for Rounds 1 to 26 clubs
27	3 April 2027	
28	10 April 2027	
29	17 April 2027	
30	24 April 2027	Concluding Round

G.2 Knockout Calendar

Stage	Date
Championship Playoff quarter-finals	8 and 9 May 2027
Championship Playoff semi-finals	15 and 16 May 2027
Championship Final, Fixture 1	29 May 2027
Championship Final, Fixture 2	30 May 2027
Championship Final, Fixture 3 if required	31 May 2027
Promotion Playoff semi-finals	1 May 2027
Promotion Final	7 May 2027
Survival Fixture	9 May 2027
Valmora Cup Final	12 June 2027

G.3 Note on Calendar Discrepancies

G.3.1 The dates in G.1 are those published on 15 July 2026 in accordance with Article 6.3 and reflect the extended calendar approved by the CEFA Board.

G.3.2 Article 4.6 states that the Elite Division regular season concludes on 28 March 2027. That provision was drafted before the approval of the extended calendar and is to be read as referring to the conclusion of Round 26.

G.3.3 Where a date in this Appendix conflicts with a date stated in the body of this Rulebook, the date in this Appendix prevails, and the Competition Manager shall issue a circular recording the correction.

APPENDIX H — SUMMARY OF DEADLINES AND PERIODS

H.1 Registration and Transfers

Matter	Period or deadline	Provision
Primary Transfer Window	1 July to 25 August	Article 17.1
Secondary Transfer Window	27 December to 14 January	Article 17.2
Player registration deadline for a Fixture	23:59 Tuesday before the Match Window	Article 13.2
CEFA decision on a registration	48 hours from complete filing	Article 13.6
Restoration of a Roster below minimum	28 days	Article 14.6
Minimum loan duration	60 days	Article 19.5
Early termination of a loan, notice	7 days before the Match Window	Article 19.6
Emergency signing, minimum contract	30 days	Article 20.3
Emergency signing, Playoff eligibility	Registered before 1 March	Article 20.4
Training compensation claim	90 days from the transfer	Article 22.4

H.2 Licensing and Finance

Matter	Period or deadline	Provision
Licence application	30 June	Article 7.3
Licensing decision	20 July	Article 7.5
Appeal against licence refusal	7 days	Article 7.6
First licence fee instalment	1 August	Article 8.5
Second licence fee instalment	15 November	Article 8.5
Restoration of the Financial Reserve	21 days from notice	Article 9.4
Inspection of the Reserve account, notice	7 days	Article 9.6
Payment of a fine	30 days from finality	Article 63.1
Return of the Licence Deposit	60 days from the end of the Season	Article 62.2
Satisfaction of a financial decision	30 days	Article 55.5

H.3 Competition and Discipline

Matter	Period or deadline	Provision
Publication of the Season calendar	15 July	Article 6.3
CEFA notice to reschedule a Fixture	72 hours	Article 6.4
Club request to reschedule	14 days before the Fixture	Article 6.5
Grace period before forfeiture	8 minutes	Article 6.8
Interval between Leg A and Leg B	5 to 12 minutes	Article 6.7
Notification of a substitution	2 minutes before kick-off of Leg B	Article 28.4
Connection Check	10 to 30 minutes before kick-off	Article 41.5
Filing of the Match Report	4 hours	Article 36.6
Filing of a protest	2 hours from the conclusion of the Fixture	Article 53.2
Decision on a protest	24 hours	Article 53.6
Filing of an appeal	48 hours from the reasoned decision	Article 54.2
Decision of the Appeals Panel, ordinary	10 days	Article 54.6
Decision of the Appeals Panel, competition composition	4 days	Article 54.6
Referral to arbitration	21 days	Article 56.1
Decision of the Disciplinary Panel	14 days from the hearing	Article 52.4
Reporting an approach to manipulate a Fixture	24 hours	Article 45.5
Reporting a software defect	24 hours	Article 44.4

H.4 Technical and Media

Matter	Period or deadline	Provision
Technical Committee decision on a new build	72 hours from release	Article 43.1
Notice of a build change, ordinary	4 days	Article 43.6
Notice of an Emergency Hotfix	24 hours	Article 43.6
Club observation on a build change	48 hours	Article 43.7
Patch Freeze before the Championship Playoffs	10 days	Article 43.3
Patch Freeze before the Final	14 days	Article 43.4

Matter	Period or deadline	Provision
Pre-Fixture interview	Not less than 15 minutes before kick-off	Article 57.1
Post-Fixture interview	Within 20 minutes	Article 57.2
Post-Fixture press conference	Within 40 minutes	Article 57.3
Club stream delay	Not less than 120 seconds	Article 58.2
Club highlight material	From 1 hour after the Fixture, maximum 90 seconds	Article 58.4
Jersey design submission	15 August	Article 59.5
CEFA decision on a jersey design	10 days	Article 59.5

H.5 Closing Provisions

H.5.1 This Rulebook was approved by the CEFA Board on 11 July 2026 and enters into force on 1 August 2026.

H.5.2 Amendments require a two-thirds majority of the CEFA Board and take effect at the start of the following Season, save for amendments of a technical nature under Article 43.

H.5.3 Any matter not provided for in this Rulebook is decided by the CEFA Board, whose decision is final.

H.5.4 The official copy of this Rulebook is deposited with the CEFA General Secretariat in Valmora under reference CEFA-RB-4.2-2026.